

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **LAWYER** *see pp. 110–111*
- ▶ **ARBITRATOR** Resolves legal conflicts between two parties outside of the court system. Arbitrators meet with and listen to the disputing parties, then determine the outcome.
- ▶ **MEDIATOR** Facilitates legal discussions outside of the court system. Mediators, often also practicing lawyers, help the disputing parties to negotiate effectively until they reach a mutually agreeable decision.
- ▶ **PARALEGAL** Works on legal matters, but is not a lawyer. Paralegals are responsible for many tasks ranging from conducting research and preparing reports to contacting clients and witnesses and gathering and organizing evidence.

SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent written and verbal skills and the ability to speak in court under high-pressure situations.



The ability to communicate clearly with lawyers, defendants, members of a jury, and others.



Good organizational skills for following multiple cases at once and managing court room staff.



Strong attention to detail for ensuring court room proceedings are carried out correctly.



Patience, perseverance, and mental stamina to preside over lengthy court sessions.



LAWYER Through years of practicing as a lawyer, you will gain the knowledge, courtroom experience, and professional contacts necessary to begin submitting your name to a judicial nomination commission for consideration as a judge.



JUDGE Newly appointed judges can expect to undergo specific orientation and training to ensure they are ready to serve. Typically, advancing as a judge means being appointed to judgeships within a larger jurisdiction. Career paths vary.



LOCAL/STATE COURT

JUDGE Reviews cases at either the local or state level, serving as impartial deciders for the majority of civil and criminal cases. May preside over a small claims court.



DISTRICT/FEDERAL COURT

JUDGE Hears cases involving the federal government or parties from different states. Federal judges must be nominated by the President and approved by a two-thirds majority Senate vote.



SUPREME COURT JUSTICE

The highest-ranking judges in the country. The nine US Supreme Court justices review only a very small number of cases each year, all of which are determined to be of national importance.